

Prior to departing your last overseas port, you must comply with our biosecurity reporting requirements.

The Biosecurity obligations for aircraft arriving in Australian territory outlines the mandatory obligations at each stage of aircraft clearance.

Here we've reproduced the section on our requirements prior to departing your last overseas port.

Proactive risk management

Prior to entering Australian territory, you should meet the department's biosecurity reporting requirements and ensure any risks associated with your aircraft are appropriately managed. Being proactive can assist biosecurity outcomes and prevent and minimise delays to international aircraft arrival, clearance and movement in Australia.

SECURE

We recommend securing your aircraft while overseas to prevent contamination by pests, insects, and rodents.

CHECK

Prior to boarding, loading, and departing your last overseas airport, check the aircraft cabin and holds to confirm no pests, insects or rodents are on board.

TREAT

Treat any identified risks immediately by engaging a qualified pest controller prior to departure from your last overseas airport.

APPLY

Apply all mandatory aircraft disinsection treatments correctly and in accordance with the [WHO aircraft disinsection methods and procedures 2nd edition](#).

Disinsection

The International Health Regulations (2005) (IHR) set global standards to prevent, control, and respond to the international spread of disease while minimising disruptions to international traffic and trade. The IHR defines disinsection as the procedure whereby health measures are taken to control or kill the insect vectors of human disease present in baggage, cargo, containers, conveyances, goods, and postal parcels. The WHO's Aircraft Disinsection Methods and Procedures, 2nd Edition adopts the IHR and serves as a technical guide offering recommended methods and procedures for aircraft disinsection to assist countries in fulfilling their IHR obligations.

In Australia, the department administers disinsection requirements on behalf of the Department of Health. All international aircraft arriving in Australian territory are legally required to conduct disinsection to manage insect vectors that may be present in the aircraft or in goods.

The [Schedule of Aircraft Disinsection Procedures for Flights into Australia and New Zealand V5.3](#) sets out aircraft disinsection requirements for Australia and New Zealand in accordance with WHO recommendations.

To comply with disinsection requirements, aircraft operators must use one of the cabin and hold application methods listed in Table 1.

Table 1 Approved disinsection methods

Category	Cabin and hold application method
Without passengers on board	Residual
	Pre-embarkation
With passengers on board	Pre-departure
	On-arrival

Aircraft operators must complete a certificate for all disinsection methods, except the on-arrival method, and retain exhausted aerosol cans for presentation to a biosecurity officer on arrival if requested.

Approval to perform residual or pre-embarkation methods is dependent on entering into formal arrangements with either the Department or Ministry of Primary Industries New Zealand (MPI NZ). The arrangements outline the aircraft operator’s governance requirements, disinsection application procedures and the verification, monitoring and testing of compliance with the arrangement.

If disinsection of your aircraft is not undertaken prior to arrival, you, your representative, or ground handling agent must lodge a pre-arrival report with the department, either by [email](#) or phone. Failure to do so is an offence and may result in the penalties outlined in Table 2, unless the aircraft movements are exempted per Table 3.

Table 2 Penalties for failure to give a report

Entity	Penalty	Legislation reference
natural person		
body corporate	5,000 penalty units	

Table 3 Incoming aircraft movements exempted from the requirement to undertake disinsection measures

Impacted entity	Impacted movement	Legislation reference
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incoming aircraft	actual or intended movement between Norfolk Island, the Torres Strait, and the remainder of Australian territory
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Landing places in Australian territory

Under ss237(1) of the [Biosecurity Act 2015](#), all aircraft subject to [biosecurity control](#) must land at a landing place in Australian territory that is determined to be a first point of entry under s223 unless:

- permission has been granted under ss239(2) to land elsewhere, or
- a direction has been issued under s240 or s242, requiring the aircraft to land at a specific location.

Failure to comply with a direction is an offence that may result in the penalties outlined in Table 4.

You, your representative, or ground handling agent, are responsible for organising an aircraft's landing place. More information can be found on the department's [website](#), including any extra permissions that may be required to land at some locations.

Table 4 Penalties for a person failing to comply with a direction

Entity	Penalty	Legislation reference
natural person		Biosecurity Act 2015, section 243
body corporate	5,000 penalty units	Biosecurity Act 2015, section 243

Place determined to be a first point of entry in Australia

A first point of entry determination lists permissions for specified classes of aircraft or goods that may be landed at, or within, the landing place. Each first point of entry has the facilities to support an aircraft's arrival and to manage the biosecurity risk to an acceptable level of protection.

Failure to comply with airport determinations, as instruments of the Act, is an offence that may result in the penalties outlined in Table 5. The determinations are located on the [Federal Register of Legislation](#).

Table 5 Penalties for when a person does not land at a determined first point of entry for aircraft

Entity	Penalty	Legislation reference
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Natural Person	Biosecurity Act 2015, section 237
Body Corporate	5,000 penalty units Biosecurity Act 2015, section 237

Place not determined to be a first point of entry in Australia

Requests under s239 of [the Act](#) are to be in writing. A ‘Request to land aircraft or unload goods at a place not determined to be a point of entry in Australian territory’ [form](#) should be submitted via [email](#) to the department prior to the aircraft’s arrival.

You, your representative, or ground handling agent are required to seek permission to land at a place not determined to be a point of entry in Australia and comply with any conditions placed within an approval to land there.

Failure to do so is an offence that may result in the penalties outlined in Table 6.

Table 6 Penalties for a person, with permission, who does not comply with conditions to land at a landing pace that is not a determined first point of entry for aircraft

Entity	Penalty	Legislation reference
natural person		Biosecurity Act 2015, section 239
body corporate	5,000 penalty units	Biosecurity Act 2015, section 239

Aircraft movements between parts of Australian territory

We regulate aircraft movements between parts of Australian territory. Under s618(2) of the Biosecurity Act 2015, the [Biosecurity \(Movements between Parts of Australian Territory\) Declaration 2016](#) provides the biosecurity framework.

Our external territories are:

- Norfolk Island
- Christmas Island
- Coco (Keeling) Islands

These territories have unique animal and plant health biosecurity status. Biosecurity arrangements for the territories are designed to maintain this status. You should contact the [aircraft biosecurity contact](#) at the first point of entry to clarify your biosecurity obligations, listed in Table 7, before arrival.

This framework also applies to the Torres Strait Protected Zone (TSPZ) and Torres Strait Permanent Biosecurity Monitoring Zone (TSPBMZ).

Table 7 Biosecurity obligations for regulated movements between parts of Australian territory

Origin / destination	Submit a general pre-arrival report	Disinsection measures	Pratique	Biosecurity control
Norfolk Island	Yes	No (s7, Biosecurity (Human Health) Regulation 2016)	No	Yes
Christmas Island	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Coco's (Keeling) Island	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Torres Strait Protected Zone (TSPZ)	Yes	No (s7, Biosecurity (Human Health) Regulation 2016)	No	No (s118, Biosecurity Regulation 2016)
Torres Strait Permanent Biosecurity Monitoring Zone (TSPBMZ)	Yes	No (s7, Biosecurity (Human Health) Regulation 2016)	No	No (s118, Biosecurity Regulation 2016)

Learn more about the requirements for [aircraft movements between parts of Australian territory](#).

Australian external territories not considered Australian territory (AETNCAT)

AETNCAT territories are:

- Ashmore Reef and Cartier Island
- Coral Sea Islands (Willis Island)
- Macdonald and Heard Island
- the Australian Antarctic territory.

The Biosecurity Act 2015 applies to international people, goods and aircraft travelling from AETNCAT territories to Australian territory. You should contact the [aircraft biosecurity contact](#) at the first point of entry to clarify your biosecurity obligations, listed in Table 8, before arrival.

Table 8 Biosecurity obligations for movements between AETNCAT territories and the Australian mainland

Australian territory not considered Australian territory	Submit a general pre-arrival report	Disinsection measures	Pratique	Biosecurity control
Territory of Ashmore Reef and Cartier Island	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Coral Sea Islands (Willis Island)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
MacDonald and Heard Island	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
The Australian Antarctic Territory	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Pre-flight reporting obligations for non-scheduled flights

As an aircraft operator of a non-scheduled flight, you, your representative, or ground handling agent must lodge your mandatory pre-arrival report any time prior to commencing your flight from outside Australian territory per ss47A(3), Biosecurity Regulation 2016. The pre-arrival report can be lodged verbally or in writing (including [electronically](#)).

Alternatively, you can email the [Aircraft pre-arrival report: non-scheduled pre-flight online](#) form directly to the [Biosecurity Airport Contact](#) at your intended first point of entry.

The report must include the following information, without exception:

- information identifying the aircraft, for example
 - aircraft registration or tail number
 - aircraft model and type
- the intended first landing place of the aircraft in Australian territory
- the estimated date and time of arrival of the aircraft
- the name and contact details of:
 - the operator of the aircraft, and
 - if the operator is not the owner of the aircraft - the owner of the aircraft
- details about any animals and/or plants in the aircraft cabin.

When to submit the report

As an aircraft operator of a non-scheduled flight, you, your representative, or ground handling agent must lodge your mandatory pre-arrival report any time prior to commencing your flight from outside Australian territory.

How to submit the report

Prior to departing your last overseas port, you, your representative or ground-handling agent can lodge the pre-arrival report by [email](#) or phone.

Alternatively, you can email the Aircraft pre-arrival report: non-scheduled pre-flight online form directly to the [Biosecurity Airport Contact](#) at your intended first point of entry.

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Download the full document.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/aircraft-vessels-military/aircraft/prior-departing-last-overseas-port>